

Palau International Ship Registry



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MARINE CIRCULAR 162.1

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, AND REGISTRATION OFFICERS OF MERCHANT SHIPS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS.

Subject: “THIRD-PARTY ORGANIZATIONS ASSIGNED BY PALAU INTERNATIONAL SHIP REGISTRY (PISR) TO AUDIT AND EVALUATE A MARITIME TRAINING INSTITUTION ON BEHALF OF THE ADMINISTRATION AND SUBMIT AN STCW COMPLIANCE ASSESSMENT REPORT FOR FINAL REVIEW AND APPROVAL”

Reference to par. 5 of the M.N. 199-3/September 2019,

Those Third-party organizations that provide evaluation services, subject to verification of the STCW compliance assessment scheme must proceed, based on the following minimum criteria:

1. The evaluation of the Training Institutions must be done in accordance with the minimum standards and procedures established by PISR for the approval of maritime training courses and programs, as specified in the Marine Notice 199-3/September 2019.
2. Each training course or program must be reviewed by the Third-party organization to ensure compliance with the mandatory minimum standards of the STCW Convention, 1978, as amended, and as specified in Part A of the STCW Code.
3. The Third-party organization must submit an Audit Report to the Administrator for each Training Institution reviewed which shall include the following:
 - identify the training center reviewed;
 - identify the quality system auditors who have been involved and made the onsite review of the training institution, providing verification of their qualifications;
 - identify the quality system standards or terms of reference (e.g., ISO 9001:2000 or equivalent, STCW, etc.) and the scope of the certification upon which the review was made;
 - specify the Administrator audit requirements which have been met;
 - specify the inclusive dates of the audit performed;
 - specify the courses reviewed; and
 - provide a copy of the certification issued to the training center which identifies the quality system standard used, the scope of courses to become approved and the authority, i.e., Flag, under which the certificate is issued.

In addition to the qualification requirements already established by the Third-party organization for its auditors, auditors should be in possession of Certificates of Competence or equivalent, which are pertinent to the field of knowledge under assessment.

The certification issued to a Training Institution as per above, is to be valid for a period of not more than three (3) years. Annual surveillance audits must be conducted, and the results to be made



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available to the Administrator as deemed necessary. In cases where major nonconformities are raised and it should become necessary to withdraw certification, the Administrator must be notified.

To date, the below member of the International Association of Classification Societies (IACS), has been assigned to perform audit and evaluation services in accordance with ISO 9001:2000 quality standards and may submit STCW compliance assessment reports acceptable to the PISR Administration:

➤ **American Bureau of Shipping**

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